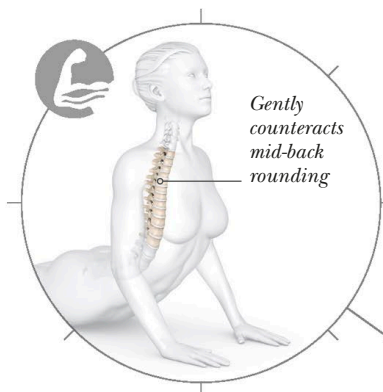


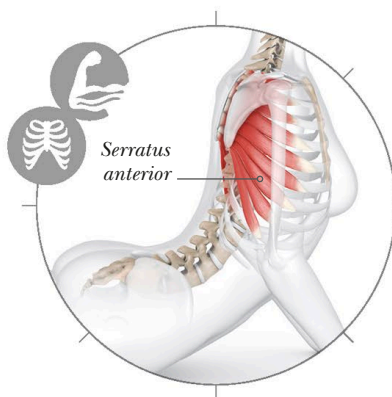
Upper back strength

By strengthening your upper and middle back and stretching your torso, you counteract hyperkyphosis (see p.14). The more passive forearm version (Sphinx pose) can also be a great option for hyperkyphosis of the thoracic spine, preventing dysfunction or a "dowager's hump."



Serratus anterior activation

Try gliding your hands back without moving them on your mat, pressing your breastbone forward to reduce pressure in your spine. This also activates your serratus anterior muscles, which help with functional movements like reaching your arms forward. Strengthening them could relieve some neck and shoulder pain.



Your rhomboids engage to draw your shoulder blades toward each other

Rotator cuff muscles engage, including your infraspinatus

Calf muscles are passive and relaxed

Hamstrings lengthen but engage to hold hips in extension

Knees fully extended

Toes and feet are pointed (in plantar flexion)

POSTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW